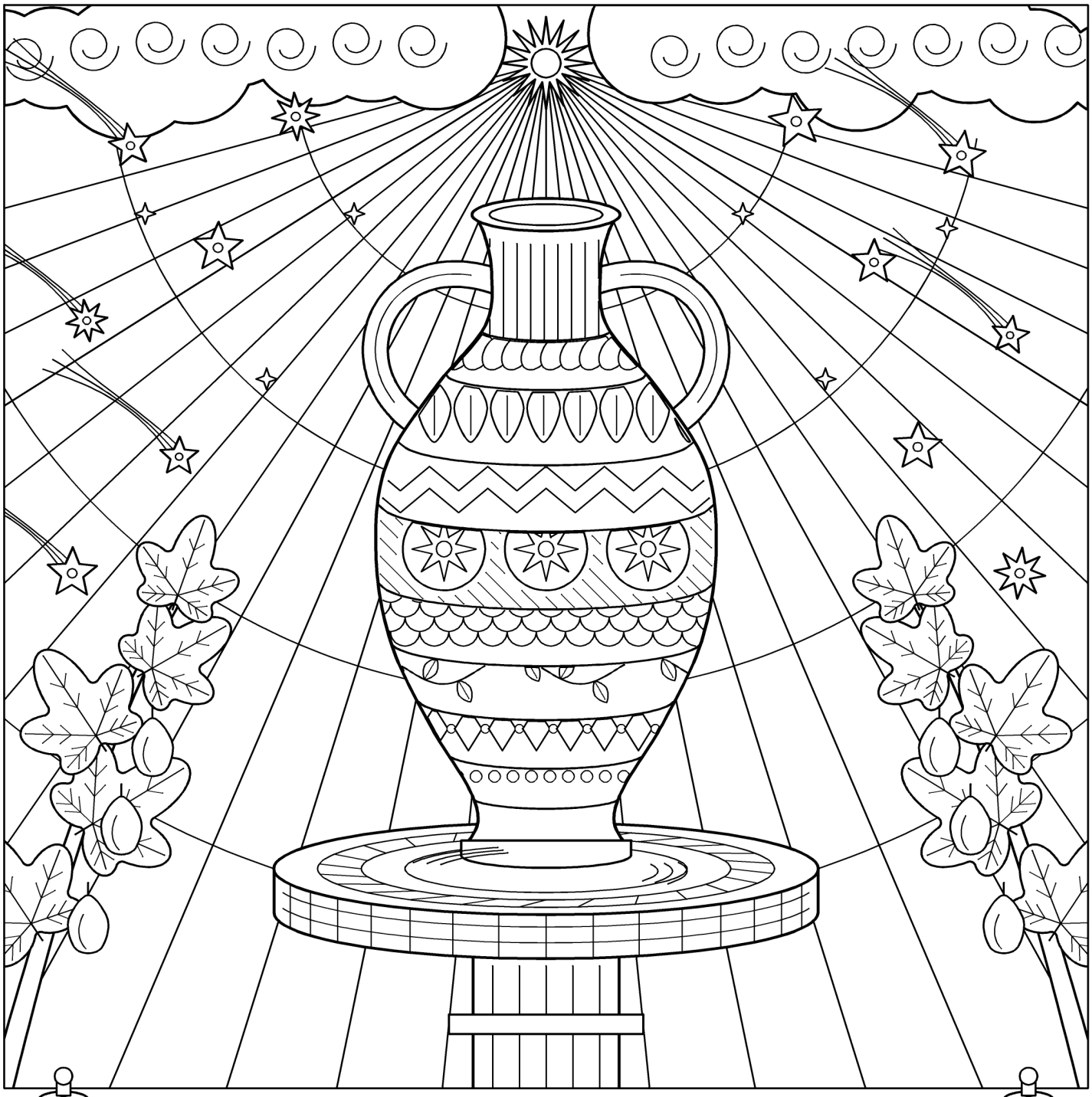
FIRST SUNDAY OF ADVENT

November 29, 2026



WATCH

We are the clay, and you our potter.
We all are the work of your hand.

ISAIAH 64:8

FIRST SUNDAY OF ADVENT · NOVEMBER 29, 2026

Clay on the Wheel

Readings: Isaiah 64:1-9 · Psalm 80:1-7, 17-19 · 1 Corinthians 1:3-9 · Mark 13:24-37

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> *"We are the clay, and you our potter. We all are the work of your hand."*
> — Isaiah 64:8 (WEB)

Advent opens with a cry, not a carol. Isaiah pleads, "Oh that you would tear the heavens, that you would come down". The prophet knows how it feels when God seems hidden. Then, in the middle of his lament, he turns: "But now, Yahweh, you are our Father. We are the clay, and you our potter." Clay does not hurry the potter. It stays on the wheel, soft enough to be shaped. Jesus tells his friends to stay awake, like servants waiting for the owner of the house to come home at an hour nobody knows. Watching here does not mean anxiously checking the clock. It is attention, the way a potter notices every curve as a jar takes shape. As you color this page, slow down. Let each band of pattern be a prayer for one place where you long for God to come down. Paul reminds us, "God is faithful". The hands that shaped you are still at work.

Prayer

Potter God, keep us soft in your hands and awake to your coming. Shape us for your purposes, and come quickly to a world that waits for you. Amen.

As You Color

Where do you long for God to "tear the heavens" and come down this Advent?

About the art: A hand-thrown jar on a potter's wheel beneath torn-open heavens, with falling stars and fig branches.

This is a free sample page from An Advent & Christmas Coloring Book (Year B, 2026) by Open Scroll Ministries. The full book has five coloring pages and devotions, one for each Sunday of Advent and for Christmas Day. Scripture quotations are from the World English Bible (WEB), which is in the public domain.